CIVILS ATLAS / RESEARCH EDITION 19

March 2025

Understand the news.
Retain what matters.

60 study notes · 30 MCQs · Mains frameworks

UPSC × Andhra Pradesh APPSC · English
Research cut-off: 7 November 2026

Read the coverage contract

Not exhaustive. Expanded monthly volumes are selected research batches; the rest of the requested archive remains incomplete. No month has passed a complete daily source audit. Full-text and source-extract evidence are distinguished. Historical notes do not certify current law, implementation or latest statistics.

New notes separate reported facts from original static connections, analysis, cautions and Mains prompts. P1 = core; P2 = consolidation; P3 = selective factual recall. Broad AP relevance is not exact APPSC paper mapping. Read the research audit for omissions and unresolved claims.

Hosted push run observed; first scheduled execution remains unverified. Automation collects unreviewed source links, not researched study notes.

Source extracts are not whole-document reviews. November covers only 1–7 November. Review research/Research-Status.md before treating any month as complete.

Subject guide

Polity & Governance — 4 notes

Economy — 16 notes

Agriculture — 6 notes

Society & Welfare — 3 notes

Environment — 7 notes

Science & Technology — 6 notes

Security — 1 notes

International Relations — 5 notes

Andhra Pradesh — 6 notes

Culture & History — 3 notes

Awards & Sports — 3 notes

How to study

Read P1 → consolidate P2 → recall P3. Review after 1, 7 and 30 days. Explain each caution unaided. Build answers with a dated fact, mechanism, limitation and conclusion.

Sources and access provenance appear in the appendix. Original analysis is not a sourced prediction of exam questions.

Polity & Governance

01 · Judicial ethics & accountability

Judicial accountability: inquiry is not a finding of guilt

VM2503-001 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-03 · web posted: 2025-04-16 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue examined institutional responses to allegations concerning a High Court judge. This is a 2025-03 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• Constitutional removal and an in-house inquiry are separate mechanisms.

• The Judges Inquiry Act, 1968 supplies part of the parliamentary removal framework.

• Asset disclosure, conflict management and reasoned complaint procedures serve different accountability purposes.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Judicial independence protects adjudication; it does not imply immunity from every form of accountability. Allegations require due process.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Transparent institutional responses can protect both public trust and fair treatment of the individual.

• Reform should provide credible scrutiny without giving litigants or governments coercive control over decisions.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not equate discovery allegations with adjudicated corruption. The magazine’s suggestion that a 1999 mechanism was based on 2002 principles is chronologically unsound.

MAINS PROMPT How can judicial accountability be strengthened without compromising independent adjudication?

Sources: [V2503-01]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

02 · Parliament & public finance

Budget Session resumes: finance and legislative business

MAR25-020 · P2 · 2025-03-10 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The second half of the Budget Session resumed after the February recess.

• The session had recessed from 14 February to 9 March and reconvened on 10 March.

• The March review records passage of the Finance Bill and three Appropriation Bills.

• Parliament also passed the Manipur budget while President’s Rule was in force.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL An Appropriation Bill authorises withdrawal from the Consolidated Fund; the Finance Bill gives effect to taxation proposals. These functions are distinct.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Budget scrutiny should connect legal authorisation with allocation priorities and subsequent expenditure outcomes.

• President’s Rule changes the legislative route for state finance, making transparent parliamentary scrutiny particularly important.

PRELIMS CAUTION Parliamentary authorisation of expenditure is not actual expenditure or evidence of programme delivery.

MAINS PROMPT Distinguish the roles of the Finance Bill and Appropriation Bills in legislative control of public money.

Sources: [M-PRS]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

04 · Citizenship, migration & civil liberties

Immigration and Foreigners Bill: consolidation and obligations

MAR25-006 · P1 · 2025-03-11 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Bill was introduced in Lok Sabha on 11 March; the review also records Lok Sabha passage during the month.

• The proposed framework consolidates four laws dealing with entry, registration, foreigners and carriers' liability.

• It provides for a Bureau of Immigration and requires relevant travel documents and visas for foreigners.

• Registration obligations and information duties extend to specified educational and medical institutions.

• The carrier definition includes passenger and cargo transport by land, water or air.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Citizenship, permission to enter, refugee protection and immigration registration are related but legally distinct issues.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Unified administration can remove fragmented procedures and improve border management.

• Data collection and reporting should be necessary, proportionate and accompanied by clear safeguards, especially in hospitals and universities.

PRELIMS CAUTION Introduction and passage by one House are not equivalent to assent, commencement or the resolution of every refugee-law question.

MAINS PROMPT How should immigration regulation balance administrative coordination, security and procedural fairness?

Sources: [M-PRS]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

05 · Disaster governance

Disaster Management amendment: urban and state capacity

MAR25-007 · P1 · 2025-03 (month-level index) · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Parliament passed the amendment Bill during March.

• NDMA and SDMA are assigned preparation of disaster-management plans at their respective levels.

• New functions include reviewing emerging risks, technical assistance, minimum-relief guidance and disaster databases.

• NDMA is to assess state preparedness and conduct post-disaster preparedness/response audits.

• States may establish Urban Disaster Management Authorities and State Disaster Response Forces.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL The disaster cycle spans prevention, mitigation, preparedness, response and recovery. Legal authority alone is not operational capacity.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Urban authorities can address heat, floods and infrastructure risks if coordinated with municipalities and land-use institutions.

• AP requires coastal warning systems, shelter access, drills and resilient infrastructure, alongside state-level response capacity.

PRELIMS CAUTION A statutory power to establish a body does not prove that every state has constituted, staffed and funded it.

MAINS PROMPT Explain how urban disaster authorities can improve resilience without multiplying administrative silos.

Sources: [M-PRS]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

Economy

06 · External sector & balance of payments

Q3 current account deficit: 1.1% of GDP

MAR25-001 · P1 · 2025-03-28 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS RBI released October–December 2024 balance-of-payments data in March.

• The current account deficit was USD 11.5 billion, or 1.1% of GDP, in Q3 FY2024–25.

• The preceding quarter recorded a USD 16.7 billion deficit, or 1.8% of GDP.

• Net services receipts of USD 51.2 billion partly offset a USD 79.2 billion merchandise trade deficit.

• The release reported net capital-account outflow of USD 26.8 billion, unlike the USD 17.3 billion inflow a year earlier.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL The current account records goods, services and income/transfers; it is not the government fiscal account. Financing composition matters alongside the deficit.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Services and remittances can cushion the goods deficit, but do not remove sensitivity to energy prices and global demand.

• Volatile portfolio flows can pressure reserves even when the current-account gap appears manageable.

PRELIMS CAUTION This is Q3 FY2024–25 data released in March, not March-only trade or the final full-year CAD.

MAINS PROMPT Why must current-account sustainability be assessed together with the composition of capital flows?

Sources: [M-PRS]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

06 · Migration & external transfers

RBI remittance survey: changing origins and state shares

VM2503-007 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-03 · web posted: 2025-04-16 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue discussed findings for FY2023–24. This is a 2025-03 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• The reported inward-remittance total was USD 118.7 billion.

• The US accounted for 27.7% in the survey; the UAE remained an important source.

• The report identified Maharashtra as the leading recipient state, followed by Kerala and Tamil Nadu.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Remittances are transfers, not merchandise exports or FDI. Survey reference periods and country/state shares must be labelled.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Diversified migration can alter remittance resilience to particular labour-market or oil-price shocks.

• AP analysis needs actual state data and migrant profiles rather than assuming all overseas income comes from the Gulf.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not infer that every advanced economy exceeds every Gulf country, or apply 2023–24 survey shares as current 2026 shares.

MAINS PROMPT What does a change in remittance origins imply for migration and financial-inclusion policy?

Sources: [V2503-13]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

07 · Digital payments & financial inclusion

Low-value UPI incentive: payment ecosystem, not universal cashback

MAR25-002 · P1 · 2025-03-19 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Cabinet approved a ₹1,500 crore incentive scheme for FY2024–25.

• Only small-merchant UPI person-to-merchant transactions up to ₹2,000 qualify for the 0.15% incentive.

• Government pays acquiring banks; the incentive is then shared among payment-system stakeholders.

• Of admitted claims, 80% is disbursed without the performance conditions; the remaining 20% depends on technical-decline and uptime criteria.

• Zero MDR does not mean that building and operating payment infrastructure has no cost.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL MDR is the merchant-facing acceptance charge; a government incentive is a distinct financing mechanism. P2P transfers differ from P2M transactions.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Public subsidy can extend acceptance among price-sensitive merchants while preserving zero-MDR policy.

• Linking part of reimbursement to reliability shifts attention from transaction counts to service quality and consumer trust.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not describe this as 0.15% cashback to every merchant or every UPI user. The approved scheme period is FY2024–25.

MAINS PROMPT Evaluate the use of performance-linked subsidies to support a reliable low-cost digital payments ecosystem.

Sources: [M-UPI]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

07 · Monetary operations & banking liquidity

Liquidity infusion: OMO purchases and forex swaps

VM2503-005 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-03 · web posted: 2025-04-16 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue reviewed RBI operations during tight banking-system liquidity. This is a 2025-03 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• An RBI purchase of government securities through OMO normally adds rupee liquidity.

• In an RBI USD/INR buy-sell swap, banks initially sell dollars for rupees and reverse the exchange later.

• Tax payments into government balances can drain banking-system liquidity until expenditure returns funds.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Liquidity conditions, the policy rate, bank solvency and credit demand are different dimensions of monetary transmission.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Operations can alleviate temporary funding friction without resolving weak borrower demand or credit quality.

• Assess tenor and the causes of the shortage before interpreting each injection as a permanent change in policy stance.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not confuse buying foreign currency initially with selling dollars to absorb rupees, or call every liquidity operation a repo-rate cut.

MAINS PROMPT Why must monetary analysis distinguish price signals from liquidity operations?

Sources: [V2503-09]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

08 · Banking & directed credit

Revised priority-sector lending directions

MAR25-004 · P1 · 2025-03-24 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS RBI revised the targets and classification framework, superseding the September 2020 directions.

• The urban co-operative bank priority-sector target was fixed at 60% of adjusted net bank credit rather than the previously planned 75% endpoint.

• The eligible renewable-energy loan ceiling rose from ₹30 crore to ₹35 crore.

• Individual credit limits for artisans, village and cottage industries under weaker sections rose to ₹2 lakh.

• Transgenders and joint liability groups were added to the weaker-sections definition.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL PSL directs a share of bank credit to specified development priorities; classification as PSL is not a grant, loan waiver or guarantee of sanction.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Target design must reflect institutional capacity, repayment risk and the possibility of misclassification.

• For AP, assess whether farmers, women, artisans and renewable enterprises actually receive affordable credit, not merely whether banks meet reporting targets.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not apply the 60% urban co-operative bank target to every commercial bank or claim that eligible borrowers automatically obtain a loan.

MAINS PROMPT Discuss how priority-sector lending can become more inclusive without weakening credit discipline.

Sources: [M-PRS]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

08 · Banking law & depositor protection

Banking Laws amendment passes Parliament

MAR25-005 · P1 · 2025-03 (month-level index) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The March monthly review records parliamentary passage of the 2024 Bill.

• The Bill amends five banking statutes, including the RBI Act and Banking Regulation Act.

• It permits up to four nominees for deposits, safe custody and lockers, with different modes for deposits and other assets.

• Deposits may have simultaneous or successive nominations; safe-custody articles and lockers use successive nominations.

• It changes the cash-reserve fortnight definition to days 1–15 and day 16 to month-end, and extends eligible co-operative-bank director tenure from eight to ten years.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Nomination facilitates bank settlement after death; questions of ultimate inheritance and beneficial ownership must be considered separately.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Clear nomination can reduce unclaimed balances and family disputes where customers are informed and records updated.

• Longer director tenure may improve continuity but increases the importance of board accountability in co-operative banks.

PRELIMS CAUTION This note indexes March parliamentary passage at month precision; re-check assent and provision-wise commencement before citing operative law.

MAINS PROMPT Assess the depositor-protection and governance implications of the Banking Laws amendment.

Sources: [M-PRS]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

08 · Competition & digital markets

Digital competition: ex ante duties versus ex post cases

VM2503-002 · P2 · Magazine coverage: 2025-03 · web posted: 2025-04-16 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue discussed proposals for a digital competition framework. This is a 2025-03 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• Ex ante regulation imposes specified obligations before or irrespective of proving a particular violation.

• Ex post competition enforcement examines conduct and liability through cases.

• Network effects, data advantages and switching barriers can affect market contestability.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Dominance is not automatically unlawful; abuse of dominance and restrictions on competition require a legal test.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Targeted obligations may address fast-moving market tipping, but broad duties can impose compliance costs on useful innovation.

• Clear designation criteria, proportionality and appeal rights should accompany enforcement.

PRELIMS CAUTION A draft Digital Competition Bill or consultation is not an enacted universal ban on large technology firms.

MAINS PROMPT When is ex ante regulation justified in digital markets?

Sources: [V2503-02]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

08 · Financial markets & regulation

SEBI board decisions: FPI disclosures and conflicts of interest

MAR25-003 · P1 · 2025-03-24 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The March board meeting approved changes to market regulation and internal-governance review.

• The board approved raising the aggregate equity-AUM disclosure threshold for specified FPIs from ₹25,000 crore to ₹50,000 crore.

• The separate trigger based on over 50% of Indian equity assets in one corporate group should not be confused with this aggregate threshold.

• Investment advisers and research analysts were allowed to charge agreed advance fees for up to one year.

• A high-level committee was constituted to review conflicts of interest, property disclosures and investments concerning SEBI members and officials.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Beneficial-ownership disclosure helps identify concentration and control behind investment vehicles; regulator integrity is an institutional-governance question.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Threshold recalibration should reduce disproportionate compliance without making concentrated ownership opaque.

• Conflict rules require declarations, recusal, oversight and transparent handling, not only a committee announcement.

PRELIMS CAUTION A board approval is not proof that every consequential circular took effect on the meeting date.

MAINS PROMPT How can securities regulators balance proportional compliance with transparent beneficial ownership?

Sources: [M-PRS]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

09 · Maritime trade & transport law

Bills of Lading Bill: Lok Sabha passage

MAR25-008 · P2 · 2025-03 (month-level index) · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Lok Sabha passed the Bill replacing the 1856 framework.

• A bill of lading is a key document in the carriage of goods by sea.

• The Bill retains rights of suit and liabilities for the consignee or an endorsee to whom property in the goods passes.

• It retains the rule on conclusive evidence of shipment in the stated statutory context.

• It adds a central-government direction-making power for implementing the law.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL In commercial shipping, distinguish a bill of lading from a charterparty, marine insurance and a customs declaration.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Legal modernisation supports predictable cargo claims and documentary trade.

• New drafting should be assessed for practical clarity and dispute resolution, not assumed to create new physical port capacity.

PRELIMS CAUTION Lok Sabha passage is not passage by both Houses. This is a month-level March snapshot, not a commencement claim.

MAINS PROMPT Why does predictable documentation law matter for export competitiveness?

Sources: [M-PRS]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

09 · Pensions & social security

UPS operational regulations: an option within NPS

VM2503-008 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-03 · web posted: 2025-04-16 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue discussed regulations for operationalising the Unified Pension Scheme. This is a 2025-03 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• UPS is an option for specified central-government employees covered by NPS.

• Its implementation framework involves PFRDA regulations.

• The operational date discussed was 1 April 2025, subject to applicable eligibility and option procedures.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Assured payout, qualifying service, contributions and withdrawal conditions must be examined together; a scheme label is not enough.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Employees need clear comparable information on risks, conditions and long-term benefits.

• Fiscal evaluation should account for contribution design and contingent obligations rather than treating assured benefits as costless.

PRELIMS CAUTION UPS means Unified, not Universal Pension Scheme. It does not automatically cover every state employee or all citizens.

MAINS PROMPT How should pension reform balance retirement security with transparent fiscal risk?

Sources: [V2503-14]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

09 · Ports & coastal federalism

Indian Ports Bill introduced

MAR25-009 · P1 · 2025-03-28 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Bill proposed replacing the Indian Ports Act, 1908.

• It provides for a Maritime State Development Council to guide data, transparency and intergovernmental coordination.

• It gives statutory recognition to listed State Maritime Boards.

• States must constitute dispute-resolution committees for specified disputes involving non-major ports; appeals lie to the High Court within 60 days.

• Ports are required to prepare waste-reception/handling plans and report pollution threats.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Ports combine Union and state responsibilities; maritime development must incorporate navigation safety, competition and coastal environmental protection.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• AP’s port-led development requires hinterland links and credible concession/dispute institutions as well as construction.

• Shared data and pollution duties can improve coordination, but central and state roles need clear boundaries.

PRELIMS CAUTION The March event is introduction, not completion of parliamentary passage or automatic implementation at every port.

MAINS PROMPT Discuss the federal and environmental dimensions of modernising Indian port governance.

Sources: [M-PRS]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

09 · Railway institutions

Railways amendment consolidates Railway Board law

MAR25-013 · P2 · 2025-03 (month-level index) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS Parliament passed the Railways (Amendment) Bill, 2024 during March.

• The amendment seeks to repeal the Indian Railway Board Act, 1905.

• Railway Board provisions are incorporated into the Railways Act, 1989.

• The stated purpose includes eliminating the need to refer to two separate laws.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Indian Railways is a departmental undertaking; statutory consolidation and organisational privatisation are not synonyms.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Consolidation can improve legal usability and decision clarity.

• Service quality still depends on safety investment, maintenance, staffing and accountable administration, not drafting changes alone.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not describe this legal consolidation as privatisation of Indian Railways.

MAINS PROMPT Distinguish statutory consolidation from substantive reform of railway performance.

Sources: [M-PRS]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

10 · Industrial regulation & safety

Boilers Bill passes Parliament

MAR25-010 · P2 · 2025-03 (month-level index) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The March review records passage of legislation replacing the Boilers Act, 1923.

• The framework regulates manufacture, installation, use and repair of boilers and components.

• The main objective is safe operation of boilers.

• PRS describes the Bill as retaining the existing Act’s provisions while seeking greater clarity in their presentation.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A boiler heats fluid under pressure; inspection, certification and operator competence protect workers and surrounding communities.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Recasting old legislation can improve accessibility, but safety still depends on inspection capacity and maintenance.

• Compliance simplification should reduce ambiguity rather than dilute accountability for hazardous equipment.

PRELIMS CAUTION Replacement of a colonial-era Act is not proof of deregulation or the removal of safety inspections.

MAINS PROMPT How can industrial regulation be simplified while preserving worker safety?

Sources: [M-PRS]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

10 · MSME classification

Revised MSME thresholds notified for 1 April

MAR25-014 · P1 · 2025-03-21 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The March notification implemented classification changes announced in the Budget.

• Micro enterprises: investment up to ₹2.5 crore and turnover up to ₹10 crore.

• Small enterprises: investment up to ₹25 crore and turnover up to ₹100 crore.

• Medium enterprises: investment up to ₹125 crore and turnover up to ₹500 crore.

• The revised classification takes effect from 1 April 2025.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL The classification uses composite investment-and-turnover criteria; these limits are not the amount of subsidy or bank credit.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Higher ceilings may let firms expand without abruptly losing category-linked benefits.

• Formalisation policy should also address delayed payments, market access and technology adoption; reclassification alone cannot solve these constraints.

PRELIMS CAUTION Both criteria matter. The tourism-project categories in AP’s tourism land policy use a different sectoral classification.

MAINS PROMPT Evaluate the benefits and limitations of raising MSME classification thresholds.

Sources: [M-PRS]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

10 · Manufacturing & value chains

Electronics Component Manufacturing Scheme

MAR25-012 · P1 · 2025-03-28 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Cabinet approved a ₹22,919 crore component-manufacturing scheme.

• The scheme is intended to attract both domestic and global investment.

• It aims to increase domestic value addition in electronics manufacturing.

• It provides differentiated incentives for component categories and seeks integration with global value chains.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Assembly output, domestic component production and indigenous design capabilities are different stages of manufacturing depth.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Component capability can reduce imported-input dependence but needs testing facilities, skilled workers and reliable logistics.

• Evaluate incentive cost against incremental local value addition, learning and durable supplier capability rather than gross sales alone.

PRELIMS CAUTION Approved funding and investment ambitions are not investment realised, disbursements or jobs already created.

MAINS PROMPT Why should India’s electronics strategy move beyond final assembly?

Sources: [M-PRS]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

11 · Energy exploration & regulation

Oilfields amendment: separating petroleum regulation

MAR25-011 · P1 · 2025-03 (month-level index) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS Parliament passed amendments to the Oilfields (Regulation and Development) Act, 1948.

• The framework concerns exploration and extraction of petroleum and natural gas.

• The expanded mineral-oils definition includes naturally occurring hydrocarbons, coal-bed methane and shale gas/oil.

• The definition excludes coal, lignite and helium.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL An unconventional hydrocarbon resource remains distinct from the host mineral; extraction also involves water, land and environmental governance.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Clarity about covered resources can reduce investor uncertainty and improve regulatory design.

• Exploration policy must account for climate strategy, methane control and local ecological costs as well as import substitution.

PRELIMS CAUTION Coal-bed methane is included, but that does not bring coal itself into the revised mineral-oils definition.

MAINS PROMPT Explain why legal certainty in hydrocarbon exploration must be combined with environmental safeguards.

Sources: [M-PRS]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

Agriculture

05 · Fertilisers & input policy

Kharif 2025 nutrient-based subsidy

MAR25-016 · P1 · 2025-03-28 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Cabinet approved the seasonal P&K fertiliser subsidy rates.

• The approved Kharif period is 1 April–30 September 2025.

• The decision concerns phosphatic and potassic fertilisers under nutrient-based subsidy.

• The estimated subsidy expenditure for the season is ₹37,216 crore.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL NBS relates support to specified nutrients; it should not be conflated with the separate urea subsidy and price-control arrangements.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Predictable subsidy can support seasonal supply and affordability.

• Balanced nutrient use also requires soil testing, extension, quality assurance and attention to relative prices rather than subsidy volume alone.

PRELIMS CAUTION The estimated seasonal outlay is not money already spent, and the NBS decision does not cover every fertiliser identically.

MAINS PROMPT How can fertiliser support encourage balanced nutrient use instead of merely higher consumption?

Sources: [M-PRS]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

07 · Producer institutions & market access

10,000 FPO milestone: formation versus viability

VM2503-009 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-03 · web posted: 2025-04-16 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue reviewed the formation programme and its institutional support. This is a 2025-03 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• The central-sector formation scheme was launched in 2020.

• Cluster-Based Business Organisations provide aggregation and professional handholding.

• Small, marginal and women farmers are among the priority groups.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Registration, paid-up membership, active trade and sustainable producer income are different stages of institutional development.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Aggregation works when input services, finance, governance and buyers address genuine member needs.

• AP FPOs should be assessed through member participation, margins and timely payments, not the number of registrations alone.

PRELIMS CAUTION The magazine issue month need not equal the date of the 10,000th formation milestone. A registered FPO is not automatically commercially viable.

MAINS PROMPT What institutional conditions make producer aggregation economically useful?

Sources: [V2503-16]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

08 · Biofuels & cooperative industry

Modified ethanol interest-subvention scheme

MAR25-015 · P1 · 2025-03-06 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS A notified scheme supports cooperative sugar mills switching to multi-feedstock ethanol plants.

• Eligible conversion allows inputs such as maize and damaged foodgrains in addition to sugarcane.

• Interest support is 6% per annum or 50% of the interest, whichever is lower, for five years.

• At least 75% of ethanol from converted plants must be supplied to oil marketing companies for petrol blending.

• The notified scheme requires applications within six months.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Ethanol blending substitutes part of petrol demand; feedstock choice determines water, food-market and seasonal implications.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Multi-feedstock capacity can improve plant utilisation when cane supply fluctuates.

• Subsidies should be assessed against food/feed competition, water stress and financially viable cooperative governance.

PRELIMS CAUTION This is not a 6% grant on project cost or an unrestricted subsidy for every private distillery.

MAINS PROMPT Assess the resource-security trade-offs in promoting multi-feedstock ethanol.

Sources: [M-PRS]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

09 · Animal health & One Health

Livestock Health and Disease Control: Pashu Aushadhi

MAR25-019 · P1 · 2025-03-05 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Cabinet revised the animal-health programme and added a medicine-access component.

• The programme addresses livestock disease prevention and control.

• Vaccination, surveillance and upgraded veterinary facilities form part of its approach.

• Pashu Aushadhi was added as a new component of the revised scheme.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL One Health links animal, human and environmental health; access to veterinary medicines must be paired with rational use and antimicrobial stewardship.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Disease control protects livestock livelihoods and can reduce zoonotic risks.

• Affordable medicines require quality assurance, diagnostic support, cold chains where needed and safeguards against indiscriminate antibiotic use.

PRELIMS CAUTION A medicine-access component is not evidence that all veterinary medicines are free or that diseases have been eradicated.

MAINS PROMPT How can better veterinary access be reconciled with antimicrobial stewardship?

Sources: [M-PRS]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

09 · Dairy value chains

Revised National Programme for Dairy Development

MAR25-018 · P2 · 2025-03-19 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Cabinet approved additional support for dairy infrastructure.

• An additional ₹1,000 crore was approved for the 2021–22 to 2025–26 implementation period.

• The programme seeks better milk procurement and processing capacity.

• Quality-control and modernisation of dairy infrastructure are part of its objectives.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Dairy value chains link dispersed daily producers to testing, chilling, transport, processing and markets; a cold-chain failure can erase farm-level gains.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Infrastructure works best when producer organisations can maintain equipment and receive timely payments.

• Quality testing and transparent fat/SNF-based pricing are important complements to expanding processing capacity.

PRELIMS CAUTION The additional ₹1,000 crore is not the entire scheme allocation or proof that new infrastructure is already operational.

MAINS PROMPT Explain how dairy infrastructure can raise smallholder income while strengthening food safety.

Sources: [M-PRS]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

09 · Livestock productivity

Revised Rashtriya Gokul Mission

MAR25-017 · P1 · 2025-03-19 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Cabinet expanded the indigenous-bovine and productivity programme.

• An additional ₹1,000 crore raises the 2021–22 to 2025–26 allocation to ₹3,400 crore.

• The programme supports conservation of indigenous bovine breeds and genetic improvement.

• New components include one-time assistance of 35% of capital cost for rearing centres and 3% interest subvention on farmer loans to purchase high-yielding breeds.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Productivity depends on breeding, feed, veterinary support and management. Genetic improvement should preserve adaptation and diversity.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Higher-yielding animals need appropriate feed, water and disease management; breeding assistance alone is insufficient.

• For AP, small dairy holders require accessible animal-health services and fair milk procurement alongside breed improvement.

PRELIMS CAUTION The ₹3,400 crore total is for the programme period, not an additional March-only allocation.

MAINS PROMPT How can livestock productivity rise without neglecting indigenous genetic resources?

Sources: [M-PRS]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

Society & Welfare

04 · Public health & tuberculosis

World TB Day: Commit, Invest, Deliver

MAR25-037 · P1 · 2025-03-24 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS WHO warned that funding pressures and missed cases threaten TB-control progress.

• The 2025 theme was Yes! We Can End TB: Commit, Invest, Deliver.

• The observance recalls Robert Koch’s 1882 announcement of the TB bacterium.

• WHO highlighted sustained investment, diagnostics, treatment access and social support.

• The statement linked resource constraints with the rollout of newer diagnostics and drug-resistant-TB regimens.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL TB is caused by Mycobacterium tuberculosis; detecting infection, diagnosing active disease and identifying drug resistance require different clinical decisions.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Effective programmes connect timely diagnosis with adherence support, nutrition and reduction of catastrophic household costs.

• Treatment success should be monitored alongside missed cases and resistance; a target year or campaign slogan is not an elimination certificate.

PRELIMS CAUTION India’s 2025 elimination ambition must not be rewritten as a verified achievement. A symptom screen alone does not confirm TB.

MAINS PROMPT Why does ending tuberculosis require social protection as well as better drugs?

Sources: [M-TB]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

05 · Credit inclusion & household risk

Microfinance: access, affordability and over-indebtedness

VM2503-006 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-03 · web posted: 2025-04-16 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue revisited the history of microfinance and SEWA Bank. This is a 2025-03 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• SEWA Bank was established in Gujarat in 1974.

• Microfinance targets financial access for low-income households and small enterprises.

• A provider’s legal form determines whether it may accept deposits; not every MFI is a deposit-taking bank.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Microcredit, SHG-bank linkage, insurance and savings are related but different financial services.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Access can help households manage livelihood needs when product design matches repayment capacity.

• Multiple borrowing, coercive recovery and poorly timed instalments can transform formal access into financial stress.

PRELIMS CAUTION Fifty years from 1974 falls in 2024; this March issue’s retrospective theme must not be presented as a new March 2025 foundation event.

MAINS PROMPT How can microfinance inclusion be measured beyond loan disbursement totals?

Sources: [V2503-12]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

06 · Wellbeing & development measurement

World Happiness Report 2025

MAR25-036 · P2 · 2025-03-20 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The annual report foregrounded caring, sharing and social connections.

• Finland ranked first for the eighth consecutive year.

• India ranked 118 among 147 countries, compared with 126 among 143 in the previous edition.

• The report was produced by Oxford’s Wellbeing Research Centre with Gallup, the UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network and an independent editorial board.

• The ranking is based on surveyed life evaluations; explanatory variables are not simply added up to create the ranking.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Subjective wellbeing complements income, health and education indicators; survey methods and uncertainty matter when comparing countries.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Social support and trust can shape lived wellbeing beyond per-capita income.

• A rank improvement should be checked against score changes, sample uncertainty and the changing country set before inferring major policy success.

PRELIMS CAUTION The six explanatory factors are not six mechanical weights that directly generate the country ranking. Rank and score changes are different.

MAINS PROMPT Can subjective wellbeing indicators improve public policy without replacing objective deprivation measures?

Sources: [M-HAPPY]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Environment

01 · Climate evidence & adaptation

WMO State of the Global Climate 2024 report

MAR25-031 · P1 · 2025-03-19 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The March release assembled updated temperature, ocean, cryosphere and impact evidence.

• The report identifies 2024 as the warmest year in the observational record.

• Estimated global annual temperature was 1.55 ± 0.13°C above the 1850–1900 baseline.

• Ocean heat and sea-level rise are highlighted as long-lived consequences.

• The report emphasises early warnings and climate services for reducing social and economic losses.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL An annual global temperature anomaly is not the same as the Paris Agreement’s long-term warming level. WMO annual monitoring complements IPCC assessments.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• For coastal AP, sea-level rise, storm surge and compound flooding make adaptation planning essential even when near-term emissions improve.

• Risk-based infrastructure, ecosystem buffers and accessible warnings should be evaluated through avoided losses and vulnerable populations reached.

PRELIMS CAUTION One year above 1.5°C does not by itself establish that the long-term Paris temperature threshold has been permanently breached.

MAINS PROMPT Explain why climate adaptation requires long-lived risk planning as well as annual temperature monitoring.

Sources: [M-WMO]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

01 · Ocean climate & fisheries

Marine heatwaves: use the percentile definition

VM2503-012 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-03 · web posted: 2025-04-16 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue highlighted studies of unusually warm ocean conditions. This is a 2025-03 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• Marine heatwaves are persistent anomalously warm ocean conditions relative to a local seasonal baseline.

• The widely used definition exceeds the seasonally varying 90th percentile for at least five consecutive days.

• They can affect corals, fisheries and aquaculture through heat stress and ecosystem changes.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A relative climatological threshold differs from one fixed global sea temperature or a universal anomaly of 3–4°C.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Coastal livelihoods require monitoring, early warning and locally suitable response planning.

• AP aquaculture and marine fisheries face different exposure pathways; a global anomaly cannot substitute for local risk evidence.

PRELIMS CAUTION The magazine’s simple 3–4°C wording is not the general scientific threshold; an independent research-group definition is used here.

MAINS PROMPT How should ocean-warming risk inform coastal livelihood planning?

Sources: [V2503-29], [V-MHW-DEF]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

02 · Cryosphere & water security

UN World Water Development Report: mountains and glaciers

MAR25-033 · P1 · 2025-03-21 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS UNESCO’s 2025 report focused on the world’s water towers and downstream dependence.

• The report’s title is Mountains and glaciers: Water towers.

• It examines mountain water and the rapidly changing cryosphere, not only glacier ice.

• The launch was set for 21 March, the first World Day for Glaciers, alongside World Water Day observances.

• UNESCO’s overview highlights water supply, sanitation, ecosystems and water-dependent economic activities.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL The cryosphere includes glaciers, snow, ice caps and permanently frozen ground. River flow also depends on rainfall, storage and watershed conditions.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Retreat can initially alter runoff and hazard patterns and later weaken dry-season buffering; effects vary by basin.

• AP’s rivers should not be labelled glacier-fed merely because a global report stresses Himalayan water security. Translate lessons into catchment, storage and demand governance appropriate to the basin.

PRELIMS CAUTION World Water Day is 22 March; World Day for Glaciers is 21 March. Do not call all Indian rivers glacier-fed.

MAINS PROMPT How should water-security planning account for upstream ecological change and downstream dependence?

Sources: [M-WATER], [M-WATERDATE]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

03 · Air pollution & environmental health

IQAir World Air Quality Report 2024

MAR25-032 · P1 · 2025-03-11 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS A March release presented annual PM2.5 comparisons based on monitoring data.

• The report ranked India fifth among covered countries for 2024 annual PM2.5 pollution.

• Byrnihat topped the report’s city list and Delhi was identified as the most polluted capital.

• The reporting said 13 of the 20 most polluted cities were in India.

• The WHO annual PM2.5 guideline cited in the coverage is 5 micrograms per cubic metre.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL PM2.5 is fine particulate matter; an annual concentration ranking differs from a daily AQI reading. Monitoring coverage affects comparability.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Airshed management must coordinate transport, industry, construction, fuel use and regional sources.

• AP cities need reliable local monitoring and emissions inventories rather than assuming a national ranking describes every neighbourhood’s exposure.

PRELIMS CAUTION IQAIR is not an official Indian statutory regulator. A 2024 annual ranking released in 2025 is not real-time pollution or a universal disease-risk ranking.

MAINS PROMPT Why should air-quality policy use both monitoring and source-specific emissions inventories?

Sources: [M-AIR]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

04 · Protected areas & landscape conservation

Madhav becomes India’s 58th tiger reserve: March snapshot

MAR25-034 · P2 · 2025-03-09 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Union Environment Minister announced tiger-reserve recognition for Madhav.

• Madhav is in Shivpuri district, Madhya Pradesh.

• It was described at the time as India’s 58th tiger reserve and Madhya Pradesh’s ninth.

• The reserve is associated with dry deciduous and thorn-forest landscapes and lakes.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL National park designation and tiger-reserve notification are different legal/conservation concepts. Effective tiger conservation requires prey, habitat and landscape connectivity.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• An additional designation can focus planning and resources, but outcomes depend on protection and neighbouring land use.

• Human-wildlife conflict mitigation and local-community participation must accompany species recovery.

PRELIMS CAUTION The ordinal is a dated March count, not the current November 2026 national total. Primary notification review remains pending.

MAINS PROMPT Why is landscape-level management essential even after an area receives tiger-reserve status?

Sources: [M-MADHAV]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

04 · River biodiversity & survey evidence

River-dolphin estimation: survey baseline and uncertainty

VM2503-011 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-03 · web posted: 2025-04-16 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue covered India’s first comprehensive river-dolphin estimation. This is a 2025-03 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• The reported estimate was 6,327 river dolphins.

• It comprised 6,324 Gangetic and three Indus river dolphins in the survey.

• The report is Population Status of River Dolphins in India–2024, associated with WII/Project Dolphin.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL An abundance estimate depends on survey coverage and detection methods; comparing unlike historical estimates does not establish a precise trend.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Flow, habitat connectivity, pollution and accidental capture are central conservation concerns.

• Dolphin protection can reinforce whole-river management, but cannot be reduced to a single population headline.

PRELIMS CAUTION These are river dolphins, not all marine cetaceans in India. Do not infer a precise population decline by mixing non-comparable past estimates.

MAINS PROMPT Why must biodiversity counts be interpreted together with survey methods and habitat condition?

Sources: [V2503-28]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

04 · Wildlife institutions & decision-making

NBWL: full-board and standing-committee roles

VM2503-010 · P2 · Magazine coverage: 2025-03 · web posted: 2025-04-16 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue discussed the full-board meeting chaired by the Prime Minister at Gir. This is a 2025-03 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• NBWL is a statutory body under the Wildlife Protection Act framework.

• The Prime Minister chairs the board.

• A full-board meeting and decisions of its Standing Committee are not identical institutional events.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Wildlife governance must distinguish policy advice, project-specific appraisal, legal approval and implementation monitoring.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Landscape impacts and cumulative pressures require evidence beyond individual project boundaries.

• Transparent conditions and follow-up matter as much as a meeting’s announcements.

PRELIMS CAUTION A long gap between full-board meetings does not prove that every wildlife statutory process stopped during that interval.

MAINS PROMPT How can wildlife institutions ensure decisions remain ecologically informed and accountable?

Sources: [V2503-26]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

Science & Technology

01 · Human spaceflight & mission safety

Crew-9 return brings Williams and Wilmore home

MAR25-030 · P2 · 2025-03-18 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Dragon spacecraft splashed down off Florida following a long-duration ISS expedition.

• The returning crew comprised NASA’s Nick Hague, Suni Williams and Butch Wilmore and Roscosmos’ Aleksandr Gorbunov.

• The return was aboard SpaceX Dragon on 18 March US local time.

• Williams and Wilmore returned with Crew-9 rather than on the Starliner spacecraft on which they had flown to the ISS.

• NASA’s post-return account describes extensive scientific and technology-demonstration work during the expedition.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL ISS crew rotation, test-flight certification and emergency rescue are distinct operational categories; redundancy is a key safety principle.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Alternative certified transport and international cooperation can provide resilience when mission plans change.

• Long-duration stays also require attention to physiology, rehabilitation, crew workloads and adequate station logistics.

PRELIMS CAUTION A return after an extended mission should not be reduced to an unsupported claim of an uncontrolled emergency rescue. This date follows the US-local mission record.

MAINS PROMPT What does flexible crew transport reveal about risk management in human spaceflight?

Sources: [M-CREW]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

01 · Space

SpaDeX: undocking milestone

CA-015 · P1 · 2025-03-13 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS ISRO separated the SpaDeX satellites after the January docking demonstration.

• ISRO accomplished SpaDeX undocking on 13 March at about 09:20 IST.

• The operation took place in an approximately 460 km circular orbit with 45-degree inclination.

• The satellites subsequently orbited independently; ISRO reported normal health.

• This followed the first docking on 16 January; later re-docking and power-transfer experiments belong to later chronology.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Rendezvous brings spacecraft together, docking connects them and undocking separates them under controlled conditions; each is a distinct mission capability.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Safe separation complements docking and is necessary for reusable, multi-module or servicing mission architectures.

• A small-satellite technology demonstration supports future missions but does not certify that a crewed station or lunar sample-return programme is operational.

PRELIMS CAUTION March 13 was undocking, not the first docking. Do not move the April re-docking and power-transfer experiments into March.

MAINS PROMPT Why are both docking and controlled undocking necessary for complex future space missions?

Sources: [M-SPADEX]

Evidence access: ISRO source extract inspected; full-document review pending

02 · Lunar exploration & commercial space

Blue Ghost lands at Mare Crisium

MAR25-027 · P2 · 2025-03-02 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS Firefly Aerospace’s first lunar lander reached the Moon under NASA’s commercial delivery programme.

• Blue Ghost Mission 1 landed on 2 March near Mons Latreille in Mare Crisium on the lunar near side.

• It delivered ten NASA science and technology instruments.

• The delivery was part of Commercial Lunar Payload Services and the Artemis campaign.

• The planned surface science period was approximately one lunar day, or about 14 Earth days.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A commercial payload-delivery contract is distinct from a government agency owning and operating every spacecraft. The lunar near side differs from the far side and polar regions.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Commercial procurement may diversify delivery options and reduce some costs, but reliability must be demonstrated mission by mission.

• Surface measurements and technology tests support future exploration without themselves constituting a crewed landing.

PRELIMS CAUTION Blue Ghost did not land at the lunar south pole and was not an Indian mission. NASA’s article date was 4 March, not the landing date.

MAINS PROMPT Assess the opportunities and risks of commercial procurement models for lunar exploration.

Sources: [M-BLUE]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

03 · Cosmology & astronomical observation

SPHEREx launches: infrared all-sky spectroscopy

MAR25-028 · P2 · 2025-03-11 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS NASA launched the observatory from California with PUNCH as a rideshare mission.

• SPHEREx stands for Spectro-Photometer for the History of the Universe, Epoch of Reionization and Ices Explorer.

• It was launched on a Falcon 9 from Vandenberg on 11 March US local time.

• It will survey the sky in 102 wavelength bands.

• Scientific aims concern the early universe, galaxy history and water/organic ices in the Milky Way.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Spectroscopy separates light by wavelength to infer composition and physical properties; an all-sky survey differs from deep observation of selected targets.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Large surveys can reveal statistical patterns that targeted observations cannot establish alone.

• Comparing instruments requires attention to wavelength, survey strategy and scientific question, not simply mirror size or launch cost.

PRELIMS CAUTION The US-local launch date is 11 March; it was 12 March in India. SPHEREx is not a solar-wind mission—that role belongs to the accompanying PUNCH.

MAINS PROMPT Explain how all-sky spectroscopy complements targeted astronomical observations.

Sources: [M-SPHEREX]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

03 · Quantum materials & experimental claims

Light-related supersolidity in polariton systems

VM2503-013 · P2 · Magazine coverage: 2025-03 · web posted: 2025-04-16 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue discussed an experimental claim involving light–matter quasiparticles. This is a 2025-03 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• Supersolidity combines spatial ordering with superfluid-like coherence/properties.

• The experiment concerns polariton systems, not ordinary room light turning into a rigid object.

• Polaritons arise from coupled light and matter excitations.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A quasiparticle describes collective behaviour in a material/system; it is not automatically a free elementary particle.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Precise identification of the engineered system prevents a striking headline from becoming an incorrect general law.

• Experimental evidence and reproducibility should be separated from speculative future applications.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not write that photons generally become an everyday frictionless solid or that a laboratory result proves commercial readiness.

MAINS PROMPT Why is accurate terminology essential when communicating quantum-material discoveries?

Sources: [V2503-40]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

04 · Heliophysics & space weather

PUNCH: linking the solar corona to the solar wind

MAR25-029 · P2 · 2025-03-11 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The four-satellite mission launched alongside SPHEREx.

• PUNCH means Polarimeter to Unify the Corona and Heliosphere.

• The mission comprises four small satellites.

• It studies how the Sun’s outer atmosphere transitions into the solar wind.

• It shares a launch with SPHEREx but has a distinct heliophysics objective.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL The corona is the Sun’s outer atmosphere; the heliosphere is the region influenced by the solar wind. Polarimetry uses light’s polarisation to investigate structures.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Understanding solar-wind evolution improves scientific interpretation of space-weather disturbances.

• Space-weather awareness matters for satellites, navigation, communications and electrical infrastructure, but research success does not imply perfect storm prediction.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not interchange SPHEREx’s cosmological objective with PUNCH’s solar objective or infer guaranteed prediction of every geomagnetic storm.

MAINS PROMPT Why is heliophysics a practical concern for increasingly space-dependent societies?

Sources: [M-SPHEREX]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Security

05 · Maritime exercises & interoperability

VARUNA 2025: India–France naval exercise

MAR25-041 · P2 · 2025-03-19 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The bilateral exercise ran from 19 to 22 March; PIB reported its culmination on 24 March.

• VARUNA is an India–France naval exercise.

• Activities included air defence, anti-submarine warfare, surface operations and replenishment at sea.

• French Rafale-M and Indian MiG-29K aircraft participated in the air-defence component.

• The drills focused on interoperability and the exchange of operational practices.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Replenishment at sea extends endurance; anti-submarine warfare requires sensing, classification and coordinated response. Exercises differ from military alliances.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Complex drills build procedural familiarity and logistics coordination beyond diplomatic declarations.

• Partnerships strengthen capacity, but operational interoperability does not erase each country’s independent strategic choices.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not confuse VARUNA with other partners’ exercises or describe its conduct as a binding collective-defence commitment.

MAINS PROMPT How do recurring naval exercises translate diplomatic partnerships into operational capability?

Sources: [M-VARUNA]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

International Relations

02 · Indian Ocean & Global South

MAHASAGAR vision announced in Mauritius

MAR25-038 · P1 · 2025-03-12 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The Prime Minister articulated an expanded cooperation vision during the Mauritius visit.

• MAHASAGAR stands for Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security and Growth Across Regions.

• The announcement was made in Mauritius on 12 March.

• The visit foregrounded maritime security, development cooperation and India’s engagement with the Global South.

• India reiterated support for Mauritius’s sovereignty regarding Chagos in the visit reporting.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Mauritius is in the south-western Indian Ocean. Maritime diplomacy links EEZ security, capacity building, connectivity and development, but national sovereignty remains central.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Trust depends on locally useful capacity and respect for partner priorities rather than only strategic rhetoric.

• AP’s maritime institutions and eastern seaboard illustrate domestic capabilities supporting wider Indian Ocean engagement, not a direct MAHASAGAR entitlement.

PRELIMS CAUTION A strategic vision is not a mutual-defence treaty or proof that every proposed project has been funded and delivered.

MAINS PROMPT How can India combine maritime security cooperation with a development-oriented Global South agenda?

Sources: [M-MAHA], [M-MAHANEWS]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

02 · Indian Ocean institutions

IORA: regional cooperation beyond naval security

VM2503-004 · P2 · Magazine coverage: 2025-03 · web posted: 2025-04-16 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue discussed India’s forthcoming 2025–27 chairmanship. This is a 2025-03 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• IORA is an intergovernmental association established in 1997.

• Its secretariat is in Mauritius.

• Its agenda links sustainable development and cooperation across the Indian Ocean region.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL IORA, BIMSTEC and the Indian Ocean Naval Symposium are distinct institutions with different membership and mandates.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Cooperation in disaster management, fisheries and maritime capacity can supply useful regional public goods.

• AP’s ports and coastal institutions can connect to wider capacity building, but chairmanship is not proof that proposed projects are delivered.

PRELIMS CAUTION The March discussion of a forthcoming chairmanship is not evidence that India took over the chair in March.

MAINS PROMPT How can Indian Ocean regional institutions demonstrate practical value beyond summit declarations?

Sources: [V2503-05]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

03 · Neighbourhood & humanitarian assistance

Operation Brahma: Myanmar earthquake response

MAR25-040 · P1 · 2025-03-29 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS India mobilised humanitarian assistance following the 28 March earthquake.

• Operation Brahma provided disaster assistance to Myanmar.

• The Army’s initial medical deployment announcement described a 118-member specialist task force.

• INS Satpura and INS Savitri of the Eastern Naval Command sailed for Yangon on 29 March.

• The response involved coordination across MEA, the armed forces and NDRF; subsequent deployments require their own dated updates.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL HADR is humanitarian assistance and disaster relief. Rapid access, coordination, health logistics and host-country consent determine operational effectiveness.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Pre-positioned assets and trained joint teams can save time during regional disasters.

• The Eastern Naval Command connects AP’s maritime geography to India’s regional relief capacity; assistance should prioritise need and respect civilian coordination.

PRELIMS CAUTION This note records the initial March response, not final casualties or cumulative assistance. Operation Brahma is not a combat operation.

MAINS PROMPT Explain how preparedness at home strengthens India’s ability to deliver regional humanitarian assistance.

Sources: [M-BRAHMA], [M-BRAHMA2]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

04 · Investment protection & regulatory space

Revisiting the Model BIT: protection with policy space

VM2503-003 · P1 · Magazine coverage: 2025-03 · web posted: 2025-04-16 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue discussed the Budget’s intention to make the model investment text more investor-friendly. This is a 2025-03 magazine-coverage supplement, not an assertion that every background development occurred that month.

• India’s 2015 Model BIT replaced the earlier 1993 model.

• BITs define covered investment and investor protections within negotiated terms.

• Investor-state and state-state dispute mechanisms are distinct.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A model negotiating text is not a single treaty automatically binding all investment partners; each concluded agreement matters.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Predictable protections can reduce arbitrary treatment while preserving legitimate public-interest regulation.

• Assess dispute safeguards, legal costs and regulatory autonomy alongside capital-attraction claims.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not treat an announced model revision as a signed new treaty or assume every regulatory loss is compensable expropriation.

MAINS PROMPT How can investment treaties balance credible protection with sovereign regulatory responsibility?

Sources: [V2503-04]

Evidence access: Selected official Vision IAS public article passages inspected; original synthesis/analysis, primary-source reconciliation still open

04 · Trade diplomacy & Indo-Pacific

India–New Zealand: FTA negotiations and Raisina Dialogue

MAR25-039 · P1 · 2025-03-17 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS Christopher Luxon’s official visit linked trade talks with broader strategic engagement.

• The leaders agreed to launch negotiations for a mutually beneficial free trade agreement.

• Luxon was chief guest for the tenth Raisina Dialogue in New Delhi.

• The joint statement welcomed New Zealand into the Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative partnership.

• Capacity building, maritime cooperation and technology were among the engagement areas.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL An FTA negotiation, signed agreement, ratification and entry into force are separate stages. Tariff preferences depend on negotiated schedules and origin rules.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Complementarity in services and technology must be balanced against politically sensitive agricultural sectors.

• Trade gains require standards compliance, logistics and firm-level access as well as tariff negotiation.

PRELIMS CAUTION The March announcement does not mean an FTA entered into force or that India joined an unrelated regional trade bloc.

MAINS PROMPT What domestic-policy considerations should shape India’s FTA negotiations with an advanced agricultural economy?

Sources: [M-NZ]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Andhra Pradesh

01 · Welfare, poverty & participation

P4–Margadarsi Bangaru Kutumbam launched

MAR25-021 · P1 · 2025-03-30 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS AP launched its Public Private People Partnership initiative at Ugadi.

• The model seeks voluntary support and mentorship from the affluent for economically weaker families.

• Participants providing support are called Margadarsi; beneficiary families are Bangaru Kutumbam.

• The launch reporting describes a top-10%/bottom-20% mobilisation model.

• Pre-launch clarification said participation was voluntary and distinct from regular welfare schemes.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Philanthropy, CSR, government welfare entitlements and public-private infrastructure contracts are different institutional arrangements.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Mentorship can address education, skills and livelihood bottlenecks beyond one-time transfers.

• Beneficiary selection, privacy, grievance redress and continuity need safeguards so access does not depend on political patronage or donor preference.

PRELIMS CAUTION Launch is not measured poverty elimination. Do not present voluntary donor support as a guaranteed statutory payment to every family.

MAINS PROMPT Critically assess the P4 model as a complement—not a substitute—to accountable public welfare.

Sources: [M-P4], [M-P4PRE]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

02 · Industrial investment & employment

SIPB investment approvals: pipeline versus realised investment

MAR25-026 · P1 · 2025-03-13 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The State Investment Promotion Board approved proposals; reporting followed on 14 March.

• The reported approved investment proposals totalled ₹1,21,659 crore from ten companies.

• The proposals covered industry, energy and tourism.

• The reported employment potential was 80,104 jobs; it was a projection, not verified employment.

• The Chief Minister called for monitoring approved projects and their movement to ground operations.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Investment stages include proposal, approval, land/clearances, financial closure, construction and commercial operation. Each requires separate evidence.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Public dashboards should show stage conversion, delays, fiscal concessions and independently verifiable jobs.

• AP’s development case should weigh water, power, land and local-skill requirements alongside headline investment size.

PRELIMS CAUTION SIPB approval is not expenditure, operational capacity or employment already generated. Newspaper totals need reconciliation with official project records.

MAINS PROMPT Design a transparent investment-tracking dashboard that avoids confusing approvals with outcomes.

Sources: [M-SIPB]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

02 · Innovation, enterprise & employment

AP Innovation and Startup Policy 4.0, 2024–29

MAR25-022 · P1 · 2025-03-24 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS A March government order formalised the policy; the substantive press account was published on 26 March.

• The policy sets targets of 20,000 startups and one lakh jobs over five years; these are goals, not achieved totals.

• Ratan Tata Innovation Hub in Amaravati is envisaged as the central hub, with five regional centres.

• The report lists regional centres at Rajahmundry, Vijayawada, Visakhapatnam, Tirupati and Anantapur.

• The design includes departmental innovation challenges and proof-of-concept support, with performance-linked institutional funding.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL An incubator supports early ventures; a unicorn is a valuation category, not necessarily a profitable or job-intensive firm.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Problem-led government procurement and university-industry collaboration can improve market access for startups.

• Measure survival, follow-on investment, revenue, inclusion and durable employment rather than registrations or valuation targets alone.

PRELIMS CAUTION Hub provision in a policy is not evidence that every regional hub was already operational in March. Re-check the original GO before relying on exact incentive eligibility.

MAINS PROMPT Propose an outcome-based monitoring framework for Andhra Pradesh’s startup policy.

Sources: [M-STARTUP]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

03 · Tourism & land governance

Tourism Land Allotment Policy: implementation terms

MAR25-023 · P1 · 2025-03-11 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS March orders detailed land terms under the 2024–29 tourism framework.

• The report describes 33-year leases, extendable by another 33 years, for MSME tourism projects.

• For large, mega and ultra-mega projects it describes 66-year leases, extendable by 33 years, or project-dependent freehold terms.

• Reported construction timelines are 18 months for MSME, two years for large, three for mega and four for ultra-mega projects.

• Sectoral project investment bands and land norms differ by tourism-project category.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A lease gives time-bound rights under stated conditions; it is not identical to an outright transfer. Public land carries an opportunity cost.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Long tenures can support capital-intensive tourism if selection is competitive and milestones are enforceable.

• Coastal regulation, local access, carrying capacity and community livelihoods must constrain development, rather than being treated as afterthoughts.

PRELIMS CAUTION These are tourism-policy project categories, not the national MSME enterprise thresholds. The March snapshot does not certify that later policy amendments are identical.

MAINS PROMPT How should AP balance tourism investment incentives with accountable public-land management?

Sources: [M-TOUR]

Evidence access: Full substantive synthesis/article read; independent primary-document checks may remain open

04 · Public health & digital services

Cabinet clears Kuppam Digital Health Centre

MAR25-024 · P2 · 2025-03-07 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The 7 March Cabinet decision was reported the following day.

• Cabinet approved establishment of a Digital Health Centre at Kuppam.

• The reported estimated cost was ₹5.34 crore.

• The decision establishes policy approval, not a verified opening date or completed service network.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Telehealth can connect peripheral patients with specialists, but clinical assessment, referrals and emergency care still require physical capacity.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Digital services can reduce travel costs when diagnostics, trained staff, connectivity and referral transport are available.

• Assess patient outcomes, accessibility, consent and data security instead of counting video consultations alone.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not treat Cabinet approval as inauguration or claim that remote consultation replaces all in-person care.

MAINS PROMPT What design safeguards would make a digital health centre genuinely useful to underserved patients?

Sources: [M-APCAB]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

05 · State finance & public enterprises

APMDC debenture proposal: scrutinising off-budget exposure

MAR25-025 · P1 · 2025-03-07 · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS Cabinet approved a proposal for APMDC to raise funds through debentures.

• The reported proposed borrowing amount was ₹9,000 crore.

• The described instruments were secured, rated, listed and redeemable debentures.

• Cabinet approval is not confirmation that the entire amount was issued, subscribed or spent.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A public enterprise’s liabilities differ legally from direct state debt, but guarantees, asset pledges and fiscal support can transmit risk to the budget.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Scrutiny should examine use of proceeds, repayment cash flows, security, guarantees and contingent liabilities.

• Ratings and listing improve information but do not eliminate credit risk or the opportunity cost of encumbering public assets.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not automatically add the proposed amount to realised state debt, or assume every enterprise liability is explicitly state-guaranteed.

MAINS PROMPT How should states make public-enterprise borrowing and contingent liabilities more transparent?

Sources: [M-APCAB]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

Culture & History

03 · Megaliths & heritage governance

Mudumal menhirs: tentative-list news, not World Heritage inscription

MAR25-035 · P2 · 2025-03-15 (reporting date) · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS March reporting highlighted the Telangana site’s inclusion in India’s UNESCO Tentative List.

• UNESCO’s entry places Mudumal in Narayanapet district, Telangana, near the Krishna River.

• The site contains standing stones or menhirs in a megalithic landscape.

• The UNESCO record gives 11 February 2025 as the submission date; this note uses the March reporting date.

• The nomination description discusses proposed archaeo-astronomical associations; these should be attributed rather than overstated as universally settled findings.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A menhir is an upright standing stone; dolmens, cists and stone circles are different megalithic forms. A tentative list precedes possible nomination and evaluation.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Heritage protection must preserve the landscape and archaeological context, not just individual stones.

• Interpretation can support community tourism while distinguishing established evidence from proposed astronomical explanations.

PRELIMS CAUTION Mudumal is in Telangana, not Andhra Pradesh or Karnataka. Tentative listing is not UNESCO World Heritage inscription.

MAINS PROMPT How should archaeological heritage be interpreted responsibly without turning tentative scientific claims into certainties?

Sources: [M-MUDUMAL], [M-MUDUMALNEWS]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

09 · Epigraphy & sources of history

Ashokan edicts: scripts, languages and interpretation

E5-2503-001 · P2 · Magazine coverage: 2025-03 · web posted: 2025-04-16 · event date varies · AP-linked

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue revisited edict sites in the heritage context. Magazine coverage is an editorial index, not the event date.

• Many edicts use Prakrit and Brahmi.

• Northwestern examples also involve Kharoshthi, Greek and Aramaic contexts.

• Edicts communicate policy and administrative/moral concerns.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL A script encodes a language; Brahmi and Prakrit are not two labels for the same category.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Geographic distribution helps reconstruct communication networks with archaeological corroboration.

• AP’s Erragudi/Yerragudi connection supports regional linkage, but site-specific inscription details need verification.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not assume every edict is identical or turn find spots into a complete uncontested map of effective rule.

MAINS PROMPT How do inscriptions enrich political history while requiring critical interpretation?

Sources: [E5-V2503-44]

Evidence access: Access recorded per source; factual essentials separated from original analytical and exam guidance

10 · Early structural temples

Gupta-period temple study: avoid uniform-style assumptions

E5-2503-002 · P2 · Magazine coverage: 2025-03 · web posted: 2025-04-16 · event date varies · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The issue discussed early structural temple traditions. Magazine coverage is an editorial index, not the event date.

• Stone and brick shrines illustrate varied structural experimentation.

• Sanctum, hall and superstructure forms evolved unevenly.

• Specific sites must be studied by evidence and phase, not only dynasty labels.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL Rock-cut architecture, structural building and later additions to an earlier shrine require separate dating.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Architectural vocabulary helps compare forms without projecting fully developed later styles backward.

• Preservation should retain archaeological evidence of multiple phases.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not claim every Gupta temple combines mature Nagara and Dravida forms or has a tall shikhara.

MAINS PROMPT Why must temple architecture be studied as a regional and chronological process?

Sources: [E5-V2503-45]

Evidence access: Access recorded per source; factual essentials separated from original analytical and exam guidance

Awards & Sports

01 · International sport

India wins the 2025 ICC Champions Trophy

MAR25-042 · P3 · 2025-03-09 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS India defeated New Zealand in the final in Dubai.

• India won the final by four wickets.

• The final was played in Dubai, United Arab Emirates, on 9 March.

• The competition began in February and concluded in March; its title result belongs in March.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL The Champions Trophy is an ODI tournament, distinct from the ODI World Cup and the T20 World Cup.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• For factual recall, pair winner, runner-up, format, venue and date rather than memorising every match score.

• A sports result can support broader discussion of institutions and participation, but one victory does not establish population-wide sporting development.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not put the winner in the February snapshot merely because the tournament started that month.

MAINS PROMPT Why should sports-development policy track participation and infrastructure as well as elite victories?

Sources: [M-CHAMPS]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

02 · Scientific & mathematical honours

Masaki Kashiwara: 2025 Abel Prize

MAR25-043 · P3 · 2025-03-26 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The Japanese mathematician was announced as the 2025 laureate.

• The laureate is associated with Kyoto University, Japan.

• The official citation recognises fundamental contributions to algebraic analysis and representation theory.

• It specifically cites the theory of D-modules and discovery of crystal graphs.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL The Abel Prize is a major mathematics award; it is not a Nobel Prize category. Announcement and award ceremony dates differ.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Foundational mathematics can transform methods across disciplines long before immediate commercial applications are apparent.

• Research evaluation should preserve space for sustained abstract work alongside mission-oriented science.

PRELIMS CAUTION The official laureate year is 2025; one inspected newspaper headline incorrectly labelled it 2024. Prefer the prize authority.

MAINS PROMPT Why should science policy support foundational research whose applications are not immediately predictable?

Sources: [M-ABEL], [M-ABELDATE]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

03 · Cinema & cultural recognition

Anora wins Best Picture at the 97th Academy Awards

MAR25-044 · P3 · 2025-03-02 · National / other

WHY IN THE NEWS The ceremony was held on 2 March US local time, corresponding to 3 March in India.

• Anora won Best Picture.

• Sean Baker won Best Director for Anora.

• The film received five awards overall; the total for the film differs from an individual winner’s award tally.

STATIC CONNECTION · ORIGINAL The Oscars are conferred by the Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences. Ceremony year and the release year of eligible films need not be identical.

ANALYSIS · ORIGINAL GUIDANCE

• Independent film recognition can prompt discussion of creative industries, distribution and cultural expression.

• Award success is a selective indicator of recognition, not a complete measure of a national film industry’s output or inclusion.

PRELIMS CAUTION Do not confuse the five awards for Anora with the number personally won by Sean Baker, or treat the US date as India’s local date.

MAINS PROMPT What enables independent cinema to find audiences beyond major commercial distribution networks?

Sources: [M-OSCARS]

Evidence access: Source extract(s) inspected; full-document review pending

March 2025 recall laboratory

30 original questions, not previous-year questions. Answers follow all questions. Historical monthly snapshot only.

1. Q3 FY2024–25 current account deficit in the March RBI release was:

A. 6.5% of GDP

B. 4.4% of GDP

C. A 10% surplus

D. 1.1% of GDP

2. Who initially receives the government’s low-value UPI incentive?

A. The acquiring bank, with subsequent sharing among stakeholders

B. Only cash-paying merchants

C. Every securities exchange

D. Every retail customer

3. Which transaction qualifies under the March-approved UPI scheme?

A. Only foreign-currency card payments

B. Small-merchant P2M UPI up to ₹2,000

C. Every payment above ₹2,000

D. Every P2P transfer

4. The revised UCB priority-sector target was:

A. 100%

B. 75%

C. 60%

D. 40%

5. Which addition was explicitly recorded under PSL weaker sections?

A. Transgenders and joint liability groups

B. Only multinational companies

C. Only foreign banks

D. All stock brokers

6. Which Banking Laws nomination statement is correct?

A. Four nominees are compulsory

B. Nomination proves final inheritance in every case

C. Every asset permits identical nomination modes

D. Deposits may have simultaneous or successive nominees, while lockers use successive nomination

7. The March MSME notification made the micro-enterprise limits:

A. ₹125 crore / ₹500 crore

B. ₹1 crore / ₹5 crore unchanged

C. ₹2.5 crore / ₹10 crore

D. ₹25 crore investment / ₹100 crore turnover

8. When do the revised national MSME classification thresholds take effect?

A. 1 July 2026

B. 21 March 2025 in every case

C. 1 April 2025

D. 1 January 2025

9. Which is excluded from the revised mineral-oils definition?

A. Coal-bed methane

B. Shale oil

C. Naturally occurring hydrocarbons

D. Helium

10. The Railways amendment principally consolidated provisions concerning:

A. Municipal bus permits

B. The Reserve Bank into the Companies Act

C. The Railway Board into the Railways Act

D. Private airline leasing

11. The March Indian Ports Bill event was:

A. Repeal by a state municipal council

B. A Supreme Court injunction on all shipping

C. Introduction in Lok Sabha

D. Universal implementation at every port

12. A bill of lading is associated primarily with:

A. Carriage of goods by sea

B. Veterinary prescriptions

C. Voting rolls

D. Currency issuance

13. The ethanol conversion scheme’s interest support is:

A. 6% per annum or 50% of interest, whichever is lower

B. 6% of all petrol retail sales

C. Available only for imported ethanol

D. A 50% unconditional capital grant

14. Nutrient-based subsidy in the Kharif decision concerns:

A. Only livestock feed

B. Only farm electricity

C. Every fertiliser under identical rules

D. Phosphatic and potassic fertilisers

15. Pashu Aushadhi was added to the revised:

A. Railway Board constitution

B. Port tariff framework

C. SPHEREx mission

D. Livestock Health and Disease Control Programme

16. The revised Rashtriya Gokul Mission total of ₹3,400 crore refers to:

A. The UPI incentive pool

B. The stated 2021–22 to 2025–26 programme allocation

C. Every state’s independent subsidy

D. Only one day’s expenditure

17. Which describes AP’s P4 model most accurately?

A. Voluntary mentorship/support complementing regular welfare

B. A compulsory tax replacing all welfare

C. A maritime military alliance

D. A guaranteed uniform statutory cash entitlement

18. Under P4 terminology, Margadarsi denotes:

A. A mentor/supporter

B. A port concessionaire

C. A lunar instrument

D. A tax tribunal

19. AP’s startup-policy targets should be reported as:

A. Funds already fully disbursed

B. Proof that all hubs are operational

C. Jobs verified by a completed census

D. Policy ambitions requiring outcome tracking

20. Why is SIPB approval not equivalent to realised investment?

A. Financial closure, construction and operation are later stages

B. Approvals are court judgments

C. Jobs always precede proposals

D. SIPB cannot discuss investment

21. Which is an important fiscal-risk question for APMDC debentures?

A. Only the number of tiger reserves

B. Whether inflation is exactly zero

C. Whether the enterprise has a social-media account

D. Repayment cash flows, security and contingent state exposure

22. The March SpaDeX milestone was:

A. A crewed space-station opening

B. The first January docking

C. The April power-transfer test

D. Controlled undocking

23. Which mission-objective pair is correctly matched?

A. PUNCH—lunar rock return

B. SPHEREx—port waste

C. Blue Ghost—crew rotation to the ISS

D. SPHEREx—infrared all-sky survey

24. Blue Ghost landed in:

A. The Martian Jezero crater

B. Mare Crisium on the lunar near side

C. The lunar far-side south pole

D. Earth’s Arctic Ocean

25. One year at 1.55°C above the pre-industrial baseline means:

A. That ocean warming stopped

B. That all regions warmed identically

C. An annual anomaly, not by itself a permanent long-term Paris-threshold breach

D. That temperature measurements are forecasts only

26. World Water Day and World Day for Glaciers fall respectively on:

A. 24 and 28 February

B. 22 and 21 March

C. 5 June and 2 February

D. 21 and 22 March

27. Mudumal’s UNESCO status in the March note was:

A. Final World Heritage inscription

B. A Telangana tentative-list site, with February submission date

C. An AP national park

D. A Karnataka biosphere-reserve notification

28. World Happiness Report rankings are primarily derived from:

A. A military-power index

B. A simple sum of six equally weighted explanatory factors

C. GDP alone

D. Surveyed life evaluations

29. Operation Brahma in March concerned:

A. A combat invasion of Mauritius

B. Antarctic mineral extraction

C. A German coalition agreement

D. Humanitarian assistance to earthquake-hit Myanmar

30. Which pairing is correct?

A. VARUNA—India and Germany

B. MAHASAGAR—an enacted customs tariff

C. Raisina Dialogue—a UN climate COP

D. VARUNA—India and France

Explained answer key

1. D The CAD was USD 11.5 billion, or 1.1% of GDP. Do not substitute the Union fiscal deficit or GDP growth rate. [MAR25-001]

2. A The primary PIB release specifies payment to acquiring banks. It is not universal merchant cashback. [MAR25-002]

3. B The scheme covers low-value small-merchant person-to-merchant UPI. Category and value conditions both matter. [MAR25-002]

4. C The revised target for urban co-operative banks was fixed at 60%. It must not be applied to every bank category. [MAR25-004]

5. A The revised directions expanded inclusion. Classification does not guarantee that a loan will be sanctioned. [MAR25-004]

6. D The Bill permits up to four nominees, with different modes by asset type; nomination and ultimate inheritance should not be equated. [MAR25-005]

7. C The new micro thresholds are ₹2.5 crore investment and ₹10 crore turnover, effective 1 April 2025. [MAR25-014]

8. C Notification occurred in March, while the revised criteria took effect from April. [MAR25-014]

9. D Coal, lignite and helium are excluded; coal-bed methane and shale hydrocarbons are included. [MAR25-011]

10. C The amendment moves the Railway Board framework into the Railways Act, eliminating reference to two statutes. [MAR25-013]

11. C The Bill was introduced on 28 March. Introduction is not enactment or commencement. [MAR25-009]

12. A The document has important shipment and commercial-rights functions; it is distinct from marine insurance and customs declarations. [MAR25-008]

13. A The support concerns eligible cooperative-mill conversion loans and is offered for five years subject to conditions. [MAR25-015]

14. D P&K fertilisers are covered by NBS; urea has a separate policy structure. [MAR25-016]

15. D The component concerns veterinary medicine access within the animal-health programme. [MAR25-019]

16. B The extra ₹1,000 crore raises the multi-year allocation; it is not March-only realised expenditure. [MAR25-017]

17. A The design mobilises support for weaker families. Voluntary philanthropy is not a substitute for public entitlements. [MAR25-021]

18. A Margadarsi refers to supporters/mentors; beneficiary families are Bangaru Kutumbam. [MAR25-021]

19. D Targets for startups and jobs are not achieved counts. Hub operation and enterprise survival need separate evidence. [MAR25-022]

20. A A proposal pipeline must be tracked through clearances, financing, construction and commercial operation. [MAR25-026]

21. D Listed/rated debt still has repayment and possible budget-support risks. Approval does not prove issuance. [MAR25-025]

22. D ISRO undocked the satellites on 13 March, after docking them on 16 January. [CA-015]

23. D SPHEREx performs an infrared survey; PUNCH studies corona/solar-wind linkage and Blue Ghost delivered lunar payloads. [MAR25-028]

24. B NASA places the landing near Mons Latreille in Mare Crisium on 2 March. [MAR25-027]

25. C The Paris long-term warming concept must be distinguished from an individual year’s anomaly and variability. [MAR25-031]

26. B The 2025 water report launch on 21 March coincided with the first World Day for Glaciers, not the date of World Water Day. [MAR25-033]

27. B UNESCO records Telangana and an 11 February submission date; the March note concerns subsequent reporting. [MAR25-035]

28. D The explanatory factors help interpret differences; they do not mechanically create the life-evaluation ranking. [MAR25-036]

29. D It was a coordinated HADR response to the 28 March earthquake. [MAR25-040]

30. D VARUNA is a bilateral India–France naval exercise. MAHASAGAR is a cooperation vision, not an enacted tariff. [MAR25-041]

Mains answer laboratory

Original frameworks, not previous-year questions, official answers or exam predictions. Keep March snapshots separate from later legal and operational developments.

1. How can India finance a reliable zero-MDR payments ecosystem? · 250 words

Opening: Low-cost use does not mean payment infrastructure is costless. Cite the March-approved ₹1,500 crore low-value UPI incentive for FY2024–25.

Build: Explain acquiring banks, ecosystem sharing, small-merchant acceptance, digital footprints, uptime and technical declines. Connect performance-linked reimbursement with service quality.

Counterpoint: Permanent subsidy dependence, exclusion of low-connectivity users, fraud and grievance failures can weaken inclusion despite rising transaction counts.

AP application: Measure merchant continuity, failed payments, rural connectivity and accessible dispute resolution, not just app installations.

Conclude: Combine transparent and targeted support with reliability, competition and consumer protection.

Avoid: Calling the incentive universal merchant cashback. Reference: MAR25-002.

2. Can MSME reclassification solve the problem of small-firm growth? · 250 words

Opening: Use the March notification, effective 1 April, to explain why higher ceilings may reduce incentives to remain artificially small.

Build: Link classification with credit, procurement and compliance. Explain both investment and turnover criteria, then discuss delayed payments, technology, skills, logistics and market access.

Counterpoint: Raising ceilings can expand the eligible pool without ensuring benefits reach the smallest or informal firms; weak implementation and payment delays remain binding constraints.

AP application: Connect startup support and enterprise investment tracking, but distinguish a startup from an MSME and national thresholds from tourism-project categories.

Conclude: Combine proportionate thresholds with prompt payment, productivity support and outcome-based evaluation.

Avoid: Treating classification as an automatic loan or grant. References: MAR25-004, 014, 022–023.

3. What makes urban disaster governance effective? · 250 words

Opening: Introduce the March-passed Disaster Management amendment and the possibility of Urban Disaster Management Authorities.

Build: Integrate hazard maps, drainage, building safety, land use, early warnings, drills, relief standards and post-disaster learning. Specify coordination with elected municipalities and state agencies.

Counterpoint: New bodies can reproduce fragmentation if staffing, resources, information sharing and responsibility are unclear.

AP application: Cyclone-prone coastal settlements need last-mile warning access, inclusive shelters and resilient utilities. Compare preparedness with the capabilities used in regional HADR.

Conclude: Judge governance by reduced vulnerability and recoverability, not by the number of authorities constituted.

Avoid: Assuming statutory permission establishes an operational body everywhere. References: MAR25-007, 040.

4. Can voluntary philanthropy complement accountable welfare? · 250 words

Opening: Present AP’s P4 model as a voluntary mentorship/support arrangement launched on 30 March, not as a new guaranteed uniform cash entitlement.

Build: Explain potential benefits in education, skills, networks and livelihood problem-solving. Discuss transparent family selection, informed participation, privacy, grievance redress and independent monitoring.

Counterpoint: Donor preference, unequal geography, discontinuity and patronage can undermine fairness. Public services and enforceable entitlements cannot depend solely on donations.

AP application: Track sustained changes in school retention, income security and vulnerability, not just families matched with mentors.

Conclude: Philanthropy adds value when it complements universal public responsibility and respects beneficiary dignity.

Avoid: Reporting launch as verified poverty elimination. Reference: MAR25-021.

5. How should states assess investment-led development? · 250 words

Opening: Distinguish a proposal, approval, financial closure, construction, production and sustained employment.

Build: Evaluate public-land opportunity cost, infrastructure, fiscal incentives, water and power demand, skills and local linkages. Build a stage-wise dashboard with independent verification.

Counterpoint: Headline approvals can overstate realised gains; listed public-enterprise borrowing can still create contingent budget exposure.

AP application: Use SIPB’s March proposal pipeline, tourism land terms and APMDC’s debenture proposal as different examples—not additive measures of realised development.

Conclude: Tie incentives to transparent milestones and net public benefit, with clawbacks where legally appropriate.

Avoid: Adding projected jobs to current employment or assuming approval proves borrowing issuance. References: MAR25-023, 025–026.

6. Why is the annual 1.5°C headline insufficient for adaptation planning? · 150 words

Opening: Cite WMO’s 2024 annual anomaly reported in March, and distinguish it from long-term Paris warming.

Build: Explain ocean heat, sea-level rise, exposure, vulnerability, compound hazards and long asset lifetimes. Connect scientific monitoring with local risk scenarios and inclusive warnings.

Counterpoint: Uncertainty about the exact future path is not a reason to defer robust, low-regret measures.

AP application: Coastal land use, drainage, ecosystem buffers and resilient utilities should be assessed over their service lives.

Conclude: Pair emissions reduction with risk-based adaptation and measurable protection of vulnerable communities.

Avoid: Calling a single year’s anomaly a permanent long-term threshold breach. Reference: MAR25-031.

7. How can maritime diplomacy combine security and development? · 250 words

Opening: Use the MAHASAGAR announcement in Mauritius to connect development, capacity building and regional security.

Build: Discuss partner sovereignty, EEZ monitoring, connectivity, skills, climate resilience, humanitarian response and dependable implementation. Explain how exercises such as VARUNA build practical coordination without constituting an alliance.

Counterpoint: Strategic rhetoric without useful delivery can erode trust. Partnerships should reflect local needs rather than treating smaller states only as geopolitical locations.

AP application: Eastern Naval Command participation in Operation Brahma shows how domestic capabilities support regional relief.

Conclude: Credibility arises from timely, respectful and sustained public-good delivery.

Avoid: Treating a vision statement as a mutual-defence treaty. References: MAR25-038, 040–041.

8. What should responsible heritage interpretation communicate? · 150 words

Opening: Use Mudumal’s tentative-list reporting to distinguish archaeological importance from final UNESCO inscription.

Build: Explain context preservation, documentation, local stewardship, visitor management and evidence-based interpretation. Attribute archaeo-astronomical hypotheses to their sources rather than presenting all interpretations as settled fact.

Counterpoint: Sensational claims can draw attention while harming scholarly credibility or encouraging damage to the site.

AP connection: Apply the management principles to AP’s own heritage, while correctly locating Mudumal in Telangana.

Conclude: Heritage communication should make uncertainty understandable without diminishing conservation value.

Avoid: Confusing February submission with March reporting, or tentative listing with inscription. Reference: MAR25-035.

Source register

Evidence access is recorded explicitly. Most non-PRS references were inspected as source extracts; primary full-text review remains open for them.

[M-PRS] PRS · March 2025 monthly review; all six chunks read

https://prsindia.org/policy/monthly-policy-review/march-2025

Substantive article/web synthesis read; linked documents not necessarily independently reviewed

[M-UPI] PIB · Cabinet UPI incentive decision, 19 March; substantive release read

https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2112771

Substantive article/web synthesis read; linked documents not necessarily independently reviewed

[M-STARTUP] The New Indian Express · AP startup policy, 26 March; full article body read

https://www.newindianexpress.com/states/andhra-pradesh/2025/Mar/26/andhra-pradesh-government-unveils-startup-policy-2024-29

Substantive article/web synthesis read; linked documents not necessarily independently reviewed

[M-TOUR] The New Indian Express · AP tourism land orders, 11 March/report 12 March; article body read

https://www.newindianexpress.com/states/andhra-pradesh/2025/Mar/12/andhra-pradesh-tourism-land-policy-announced

Substantive article/web synthesis read; linked documents not necessarily independently reviewed

[M-APCAB] The New Indian Express · AP Cabinet meeting of 7 March, reported 8 March

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[M-SPADEX] ISRO · SpaDeX undocking, 13 March

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Official public web article: lead and selected substantive passages inspected; linked primary texts not necessarily reviewed

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Official public web article: lead and selected substantive passages inspected; linked primary texts not necessarily reviewed

[V2503-09] Vision IAS · 2025-03 edition · 3.1 Liquidity Deficit

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Official public web article: lead and selected substantive passages inspected; linked primary texts not necessarily reviewed

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Official public web article: lead and selected substantive passages inspected; linked primary texts not necessarily reviewed

[V2503-40] Vision IAS · 2025-03 edition · 7.3 Light Supersolid

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Lead and selected substantive passages inspected; not full-magazine or primary-source verification

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Lead and selected substantive passages inspected; not full-magazine or primary-source verification

Unfinished research

Not exhaustive. Expanded monthly volumes are selected research batches; the rest of the requested archive remains incomplete. No month has passed a complete daily source audit. Full-text and source-extract evidence are distinguished. Historical notes do not certify current law, implementation or latest statistics.

Daily-source reconciliation remains open for every month. Further periods remain unfinished. The monthly inventory and daily/monthly ledgers record work required, not additional completed coverage.

The automation files collect links only after deployment and enabling. No hidden researcher will fill the remaining months after this response.

Read research/Research-Status.md for corrections, exclusions, evidence caveats and close-out tasks.